

**Regular Meeting
Wednesday, March 6, 2019
Medford School Committee
Council Chambers**

Present: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke, Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent, Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell, Assistant Superintendent Kirsteen Patterson, and High School Representative Chioma Opara.

Roll Call and Salute the Flag - Mayor Burke called meeting to order at 7:20pm.

7 - Present

Ms. DiBenedetto

Ms. Kreatz

Ms. Mustone

Mr. Ruggiero

Mr. Ruseau

Ms. Van der Kloot

Mayor Burke

0 - Absent

Approval of Minutes of February 11, 2019 - Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds and Approval of Payrolls - Ms. DiBenedetto asked some questions. Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Mr. Ruseau motioned for suspension of the rules to take papers 2, 3, 4, 8, 9, 10, and 13 out of order, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

Recognition of Tristen Howard for Accomplishments in Track and Field - Thomas Lynch - I do not want to forget Coach Dempsey who helped us out but was unable to come. I have been coaching for 20 years, but this year we are very fortunate to have Tristen Howard, he is here with his very supportive mom, who stays for all track meets, they are very long days, we appreciate the support Tristen has. This young man is remarkable. Thanks to Emily Lazzaro for being patient with our schedule. Right after the holidays Tristen competed in the East Coast Invitational and placed second and third in two races. A week later he entered the Mass Coaches Association large school invitational and placed second in the dash, then a week later he won the

dash and set a record for long jump. He can only practice long jump outdoors. He was nominated and unanimously voted MVP. He became state champion. He is getting better and better and it is remarkable. He went to the all-state meet, everybody in all five divisions, he finished 4th place of everybody in Massachusetts. He finished 8th place of all of New England. Coach Joe is taking him to New York City this weekend for nationals. When you see a young person like this they make an impression on our community, our high school, our city as a whole. Coach Joe - I am his coach but I've known Tristen as a student since Freshman year. I am here to talk about why Tristen has been and continues to be a model student athlete. He is a symbol of what it means to be a Mustang. This is an email to Mr. Tucci, my nomination for Tristen as a student of the quarter for his Freshman year. I believe he has stayed on this path ever since. *Coach Joe reads his email nomination about Tristen leading by example, striving to overcome adversity, he manages his time with academics and athletics and being social and working, he remains humble.* I believe a student like Tristen can inspire students to believe they can be both a student and an athlete.

Mayor Burke - Tristen, we have a certificate for you, we wish you great success, thank you to the coaches as well.

Report on Ethics Bowl Competition - Dr. Chiesa - Ethics Bowl is an after school activity working with Tufts Department of Philosophy. It is about developing virtues that are central to democratic citizenship. They outperformed Philips Exeter, Philips Andover, Lexington High School. They had a regional victory on February 2 in the New England regional ethics bowl. Special thanks to Mr. Esner.

Recommendation to Approve Field Trip for Ethics Bowl Competition offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes. Ms. Van der Kloot - I would like to ask the Mayor on behalf of the school committee to see if we can get a donor to contribute to the cost of the field trip as has been done in the past. Mayor Burke - So moved. I will do my best.

Report on Scholastic Writing Awards - Dr. Chiesa - Over 2,600 Massachusetts students entered the competition and Medford had 3 winners. Ms. DiBenedetto - Can you send us a copy of the winning essays and poems? Dr. Chiesa - Yes, we will have sign offs from parents and students first but we also publish them on the school website. Mayor Burke - Certificates presented for Isabel Anglese, Laurel Baxter, and Dayanara Torres. Congratulations.

Report on Scholastic Art Awards - Mr. Szykniej - We had three winners of the art award. Kylie Truong received two honorable mention awards for her photography. Not only did she excel in art but she plays violin in the orchestra. She works on the yearbook and she is on the swim team, congratulations to her. Katharine Schmidt is here, she is a cellist in the orchestra and she won a silver key in drawing and illustration, she is only a freshman so gold key I think is in the future.

Cairo Keenan, who is a junior, received a gold key for his digital art project which will be on display and will be judged against other students on the national level. Congratulations to all.

Recommendation to Approve Field Trip - DECA trip to Boston - Mr. Fallon - This is our third year that we have students qualifying for nationals. This year it is in Boston, staying over Thursday night. Ms. Coolen is our advisor and has done a great job, we may need another instructor next year since it is so popular. Ms. Coolen - DECA is a competition for students. This is our third year where we have international qualifiers, which is quite an accomplishment. We have teams that have been doing these competitions for decades with hundreds of participants. Our little team of 10 has worked very hard to compete. This year to qualify the students had to create an operations manual that was over a hundred pages, they worked very hard. We hoped for bronze and we got gold. They will present on Friday, as a test run leading up to internationals. Hunter is part of the team. He and one other student from our team qualified for their role play activity. We are having success and I am looking forward to continuing. Students are very engaged. They are excited to join the business program because of this. Hunter - I have been doing DECA since my sophomore year. I love doing it. My first year I made it to nationals and you helped pay for that, thank you. Last year we made it to states. This year we made it to nationals again. We're like the Patriots! We are expanding every year and Ms. Coolen is getting more and more people joining. It looks great on your resume, and it is a great experience. We started the SB manual last year about renting out our school vans. Mayor Burke - DECA's success has to do with you as well, well done! Ms. DiBenedetto - I have spent some time with Hunter, I was shopping and taking a long time, posting pictures, trying on merchandise, I encourage everybody in the community to buy some outfits they have at the Vocational School. We are very proud of you. Mayor Burke - Good luck Friday. Motion to approve field trip offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot.

Roll call vote

Affirmative:

Ms. DiBenedetto

Ms. Kreatz

Ms. Mustone

Mr. Ruggiero

Mr. Ruseau

Ms. Van der Kloot

Mayor Burke

7 affirmative, 0 negative, motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve Donation for Speech and Language Therapists to Attend Stuttering Conference - Ms. Medaglio - I am here to request that the school committee accept a donation by

Ms. Elizabeth Gomez to donate funds to pay for the registration for school speech therapists to attend a National Stuttering Association conference at an amount of \$177. Ms. Gomez is a teacher here and she is making the donation to other instructional staff. Ms. DiBenedetto - I request that we send a thank you letter to Ms. Gomez. Motion to approve the donation offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Kreatz.

Roll call vote

Affirmative:

Ms. DiBenedetto

Ms. Kreatz

Ms. Mustone

Mr. Ruggiero

Mr. Ruseau

Ms. Van der Kloot

Mayor Burke

7 affirmative, 0 negative, motion passes.

Community Participation - Ms. Rodriguez - I am a member of the Medford Community-wide PTO and the Harlem Wizards will come here and play against teachers, staff, and administrators at the elementary schools. We can come see the newly renovated Medford basketball court. You can buy tickets online. The Hyatt in Medford has provided lodging at no cost for the team. The Chevalier is sponsoring our team shirts. Wegmans has given us some money to provide concessions. Laurie Crane from Caldwell Banker has donated 20 tickets to be given away to students. Boston Physical Therapy and Wellness will do training so parents can stretch. Ms. Mustone - Which teachers are playing? Ms. Rodriguez - Andy O'Brien, Hannah O'Brien, Makayla Kelly, Jim Garrity, Mr. Cormio, Dan DeMeo, Angela connections teacher, Suzanne Galusi, Amanda Butera, Jen Conti, Mitzi Galante, Abby Herman, Kathy Kay, Nancy Sherman-Hudson, Jeanne Duskin, Karen Roberto, Josh Glionna, Jason Drinkwater, Christina Tomino, Jennifer O'Brien, Lindsay Bello, Rocco Grover-Silvestri, Christine Hunt, Anthony Petrelis. Just elementary this year. The tickets are \$15.

Motion to revert to regular schedule offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Report of Committees - Committee of the Whole February 11, 2019 - Ms. Kreatz - We made some changes to the Function of the Medford School Committee document. I have a final original document for signatures. *Ms. Kreatz read the document.* Mayor Burke - Thank you very much Ms. Kreatz and all of you for your hard work on setting the goals. Motion to adopt the

Functions of the Medford School Committee document offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms Kreatz.

Roll Call Vote

Affirmative

Ms. DiBenedetto

Ms. Kreatz

Ms. Mustone

Mr. Ruggiero

Mr. Ruseau

Ms. Van der Kloot

7 affirmative, 0 negative, motion passes.

Report of Committees - Rules Sub Committee February 25, 2019 - Ms. Kreatz - We reviewed our schools' Responsible Use Policy. We asked to switch out the url from acceptable use policy to responsible use policy. Mr. Ruseau asked that we black out social media sites. Dr. Edouard-Vincent cautioned that YouTube can be educational and the public schools use social media to disseminate information so it should not be a total blackout, but could be used with caution. We discussed that Instagram should not be used for students under 13. There must be an educational reason for teachers to use this as a tool. Dr. Edouard-Vincent said that technology and learning goes hand in hand. We must acknowledge that Instagram should not be used for students under 13 and also that some students may not have access to a computer at home so we should be aware of the equity issue. Motion to accept and add current date to responsible use policy as updated offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion carries.

Superintendent's Updates and Comments - Dr. Edouard-Vincent - This afternoon we attended a lunch with the Japanese Consul General as a thank you to us for our partnership hosting the Japanese School at Medford High School.

CCSR has expanded to all of our schools. A few projects to highlight: Roberts CCSR recently held a soup drive. Congratulations for a successful drive. Brooks CCSR rebel recyclers began a new recycling program. They are working on collecting stretchy plastics and delivering them to Whole Foods for processing. McGlynn Middle CCSR researched local food pantries and decided to send their donations to Somerville Homeless Coalition, congratulations to them. The programs they are working on make Medford and the world a better place. Mayor Burke just signed into law the plastic bag ban that will go into effect this summer. It began as a proposal by CCSR high school student Maria Fernandes.

Winter sports season has ended. Tristen Howard placed 8th in the New England regional championships. He travels to New York this weekend to compete in nationals. March 18th is spring tryouts.

Mr. John Curley is our new Mustang football coach. We put together a committee to search for a new football coach. Mr. Curley was selected, with 12 years of football coaching experience. He is Heads Up Concussion certified. I would like to extend sincere thanks to Coach Nacimiento and welcome Coach Curley.

Medford High Athletics is hosting concussion training on Tuesday March 12 in the Caron theater from 3 to 5 pm. It is our job to keep young athletes protected. MCMC will provide the training and all are invited.

The Vocational Technical cosmetology department are working on wet styling, combining shop with academics, writing a report about the celebrity they chose to recreate. The students were very proud to show off their projects. They were so excited, I went and visited them and other students were going to view the work as well. I was proud of their work.

Ms. Alice Beth Fitzpatrick has been appointed interim assistant principal. She has been a guidance counselor for 12 years and she will be here at a meeting next time to present with Mr. Fallon.

I used the services of the Vocational shop to have them look at my car, do an inspection, repair the sensor damage. I spent time with the students. They were asking me why we had not had a snow day, the pressure was on! When they did the first check of my car and replaced the sticker, they found a nail in my tire. I was surprised and so pleased that here on the Medford High campus, you can have them service your car, they repaired it the following day. I want the community to know that you can come here and get your inspection sticker for your car, fix sensors, grab some lunch in the Bistro, we have a lot to offer here, get your hair done, go to the Mustang Mall. While I was in the automotive shop I was also pleased to see three female students, I asked what she likes working on best and she said she likes brakes!

Kindergarten registration officially started yesterday at the Parent Information Center. Forms can be downloaded from our website but registration must be done in person. Informational sessions begin tomorrow at 7pm in the library at Medford High School.

If They Had Known is a film presentation for parents about party culture. It is kids speaking to kids about recreationally mixing prescription drugs with alcohol. All parents are invited to

attend, two dates at the McGlynn Middle and at Medford High School. Thanks to Toni Wray and Rachel Perry for bringing this topic to our community.

Both of our middle schools are now hosting Lunch with the Principal. Students are selected to eat lunch with the principal. I love this idea because the principals are reaching their students and rewarding student who epitomize the Mustang Way.

Save the date: Friday April 5th 8am-1pm in Medford High School gym for Credit for Life. The State Treasurer just approved Medford High for a grant to support this event. Math teachers have added financial literacy to their curriculum so students are prepared.

West Medford Community Center hosted a First Fridays event last Friday. I was interviewed on Facebook Live about my childhood, thank you to Mayor Burke and Member Van der Kloot for attending.

Mr. Ruggiero - Will there be a neurologist at the MCMC event? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I can get that answer for you.

Ratification of Kids Corner Memorandum of Agreement - Motion to approve offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto.

Roll call vote

Affirmative:

Ms. DiBenedetto

Ms. Kreatz

Ms. Mustone

Mr. Ruggiero

Mr. Ruseau

Ms. Van der Kloot

Mayor Burke

7 affirmative, 0 negative, motion passes.

Ratification of Secretaries Memorandum of Agreement - Motion to approve offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Kreatz.

Roll call vote

Affirmative:

Ms. DiBenedetto

Ms. Kreatz

Ms. Mustone
Mr. Ruggiero
Mr. Ruseau
Ms. Van der Kloot
Mayor Burke

7 affirmative, 0 negative, motion passes.

Review of MSBA Statement of Interest for April Filing Deadline - Ms. Patterson - This is for a core project. This wording was reviewed by the administration for content and to see that we will be approved by MSBA. We have a deadline so it can go to City Council. Mayor Burke - on page 2 you mention the Everett agreement and an increased enrollment of 100, is that accurate? I think we should reevaluate that number. Based on our lunch today we spoke about this process with the Japanese School, if there is anything that we can add about them to beef up our application, we should do that as well. Ms. Van der Kloot - There is a mention of an approved cafeteria, what about the library? Ms. Patterson - These are numbered for specific criteria. We did not include the library as we were focusing on urgent needs for HVAC systems, roof, other systems that are outdated. We were moving forward with core areas that are included in the application. Ms. Van der Kloot - I was surprised not to see the library here as we had discussed it in the past. Ms. DiBenedetto - Can we have the proper number of students here as an amendment? I would like to request an update on that in a separate report. All students who are from outside the district that are enrolled in Medford Schools. Motion to accept this report offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Mr. Ruseau.

Roll call vote
Affirmative:
Ms. DiBenedetto
Ms. Kreatz
Ms. Mustone
Mr. Ruggiero
Mr. Ruseau
Ms. Van der Kloot
Mayor Burke

7 affirmative, 0 negative, motion passes.

Recommendation for Budget Discussions to Take Place in Personnel Sub Committee - Dr. Edouard-Vincent - The format is intended to inform the past years budget as opposed to future years. We would rename the Personnel Sub Committee to Budget/Personnel Sub Committee. Ms. DiBenedetto - I have problems with April 4th and some other dates. Can we change them? Can we hear from other committee members that the schedule works for them as well? Ms.

Kreatz - I have a conflict with April 4 and March 21. There is a regular meeting one of the nights as well, we could move it up to be before the regular meeting. Mayor Burke - If we vote to do this we can adjust the dates. Ms. Van der Kloot - One thing to keep in mind, we may not be able to accommodate every member's particular schedule. Ms. Patterson is available on Mondays and Thursdays. I think as many members as can make the meetings can make them. Mr. Ruseau - Non-sub committee members attending is perfectly legal but I remember that the Attorney General's advice is that we should sit quietly and not participate. I think it would be useful to get Mr. Greenspan's advice about if we can come and stay quiet. I would like his approval. Mayor Burke - We can get his opinion. Mr. Ruggiero - I am opposed to this plan. It is part of my fiduciary responsibility to review these issues and we should do it in committee of the whole. I think this is the wrong direction and we should all be present at these meetings. Ms. Van der Kloot - The only question becomes the scheduling. How do we handle this? Ms. Patterson - Previously budget line items were presented by department heads at the school committee level and the budget was approved. This is a more transparent process, with more opportunity for school committee members to deliberate. This is a mechanism to show where we've been, where we are now, where we plan to go, so we are all on the same page and building a budget together. Ms. Mustone - We only have 3 roles: set policy, oversee the budget, hire and supervise the superintendent. I believe we should stay with the way it was done in the past so we all hear from the departments. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We have 7 sub committees. The premise is that the members there are given the authority to think about particular issues which then affect the whole district. The sub committee members would be able to speak in greater detail about the rationale. We could sit down and spend 6 or 7 hours going through this, it gets late, how sharp can we be? I am happy to speak with Howard for legal guidance on how it can happen. By breaking it out this way it allows us to have greater dialogue and more meaningful conversation. I think it will bring greater participation from the school community and greater transparency about the process. Mr. Ruseau - I support this even if I am not allowed at this meeting. Last year I had a million questions I couldn't get answers to because it was the whole committee and there was no time. If we got into the detail we need to get into, our meetings would last until 3am. I would give up the option to dig in over what I felt last year was a waving of the wand and saying we know the budget. Every other school committee has a finance committee to do this, we are the strange ones who don't. Mr. Ruggiero - What is the personnel sub committee for? To decide if we want a badminton coach. A conversation about how personnel should be hired. The premise that 7 of us can not sit together and have a conversation about it is offensive. A quorum is 4 people. We can do that. In terms of collaboration and conversation, I support that effort at transparency. I think we should throw ideas on the board and see what sticks. We are not the weirdos. We use the process to see what is going on for the community on camera. I do not think having meetings in sub committee where there is no camera is more transparent for the community. Ms. DiBenedetto - I like the idea of this process tremendously. The spirit of it is excellent. It can be committee of the whole exactly what you're talking about, but with everyone.

Ms. Van der Kloot - The first proposed date is March 14. Mayor Burke - I do not think we should worry about the dates, just the idea. Ms. Van der Kloot - As a pragmatic question, can we even do that? It would be easier if it were a smaller group, but I have to listen to my colleagues. If I was not on the sub committee, I would be arguing too, which is not okay. Can we do March 14 as a committee of the whole? Mr. Ruseau - I'm going to attend every one of these meetings, I will be at any date you put down, even if I have to sit silently. I am fine with committee of the whole if it is done rationally. The mayor should schedule the committee of the whole and we show up or do not. Ms. Kreatz - Can we do them before regular meetings? Mayor Burke - Not everyone can make that. Ms. Van der Kloot - If I made a motion that we have committee of the whole on March 14, can that happen? Mayor Burke - I just have not looked at my calendar. The administrators need to prepare documents. Motion to create committee of the whole for conducting pre budget hearings in the evening offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto.

Roll call vote

Affirmative:

Ms. DiBenedetto

Ms. Kreatz

Ms. Mustone

Mr. Ruggiero

Mr. Ruseau

Ms. Van der Kloot

Mayor Burke

7 affirmative, 0 negative, motion passes.

Mayor Burke - We may have later school committee starting at 8. We will work through the kinks.

Report on New Standards for Social Studies - Dr. Chiesa - This is a significant change to my department and I want to make sure you are aware of the changes. We have been working on this for this school year and the prior year as well anticipating these changes. The framework involves a significant emphasis on civic engagement. DESE is targeting grade 8 for assessments. We do not know yet which grade it will be for the high school, but it will be coming and that decision will impact decisions I make about curriculum. It is a great program focused on civics education, we are all very excited about this. We have already had good involvement but now it's the law that there be greater opportunities for students to get involved. The most impact is felt in grade 8, moving away from US History 1 and into Civics, which is great. Staff has been involved and now we have the framework. We have engaged with this in every department meeting. We will also be delving deeply on March 12 for professional development day. We will

make the transition methodical and thoughtful. We will be reviewing and applying for any grants and getting involved in the commonwealth civics challenge. Mr. Ruggiero - The assessment will be an MCAS design? Dr. Chiesa - Yes, MCAS design. There will be three levels: elementary, secondary, high school. There are unanswered questions DESE can't answer yet. We know grade 8 will be one of those MCAS scored. They also have a lot of other tests that year. Mr. Ruggiero - Will there be more expenditures for grade 8? Dr. Chiesa - Yes. Mr. Ruggiero - Support from the state? Dr. Chiesa - We do not know yet, we are taking it slow deciding on materials. I do anticipate some of these needs coming up in budget conversations. Mr. Ruggiero - Has DESE published the curriculum, topics that will be tested? Dr. Chiesa - No, they just told us it was going to be grade 8 at the last meeting. Mr. Ruggiero - Thank you for the report, please keep us updated. Dr. Chiesa - We are excited and we have it under control. Motion to accept the report and place on file offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Condolences to the family of Rosemary Teixeira, mother of Paul Teixeira, and Stephen Pina, 43 year veteran of the Medford Fire Department.

Ms. DiBenedetto - Can we add the follow-up report on student activities accounts to the next agenda so I can ask questions? Mayor Burke - Yes.

Motion to adjourn at 9:11pm